Northern Devon Healthcare NHS Trust

ASSESSMENT OF CLINICAL COMPETENCY

Competency:

Management of Patient Controlled Epidural Analgesia (PCEA)

Aim and Objectives:	The practitioner is able to demonstrate supporting knowledge, understanding and has been observed as competent in management of patient controlled epidural analgesia (PCEA)
Training Prerequisite:	Prior to this assessment, the practitioner has successfully completed the following: Patient Controlled Analgesia e-learning on STAR
Your responsibility:	All staff should ensure that they keep their knowledge and skills up to date by accessing up to date information through local policies, standard operating procedures and guidance. It is the responsibility of the individual to work within their own sphere of competence relevant to their job role and to follow their Code of Conduct/Standards of Proficiency
Employee Signature/print name: ……. Date: ……..	

Policies and Procedures:	Date policy read by practitioner and initials
NDHT Acute Pain Management Policy	
NDHT Infection control policy	
NDHT Medical devices policy	
NDHT Injectable Medicines Policy	
NDHT Pain management electronic resource file (POW)	

Competency Statement:

The practitioner has been observed as competent in the task of management of patient controlled epidural analgesia on the date/s recorded below:

Underpinning knowledge and understanding required:	Date of assessment and assessor initials
Demonstrates a working knowledge of medication storage, handling, administration, and health and safety issues (e.g. COSHH)	
Demonstrates an understanding of accountability with regards to the administration of medications	
Demonstrates a working knowledge of the hazards and complications which can be related to the administration of medications via the prescribed route	
Demonstrates a knowledge of common medication types for clinical area via the prescribed route	
Demonstrates a working knowledge of current best practice when administrating medications via the prescribed route	
Demonstrates a working understanding of the demand for physiological measurements and why it is vital to monitor the effects of medications	
Demonstrates a working knowledge of possible adverse reactions, how they may be recognised and discusses the appropriate actions to be taken	
Demonstrates a working knowledge of drug calculations relevant to prescribed route	
Demonstrates an in depth understanding of the safe custody of medications within their clinical area	
Demonstrates an understanding of common side effects of medications being administered and treatment of side effects	
Discusses the various medical devices available to assist in administering of medications	
Demonstrates a knowledge of how to recognise the clinical indications of infection, epidural haematoma, Dural puncture and local anaesthetic toxicity and takes appropriate action in line with trust policy	
Demonstrates a knowledge of the importance of keeping records and relevant documents to be used when administering and monitoring of PCA	
Demonstrates a working knowledge of the anatomy and physiology of the circulatory system	
Recognises their own sphere of competence and demonstrates a working knowledge of how to refer concerns to a relevant staff member	
Demonstrates an understanding of the relevant National and Local policies (listed above)	

Assessment of Competency:

Performance Criteria	Date of assessment and assessor initials
Checks and confirms patient identity	
Reads prescription correctly	
Competent in using pump in line with trust competencies	
Ensure Infusion device is delivering accurately and record delivered rate and volume	
Ensure patient fully understands and is able to give informed consent in using PCEA	
Ensure patient is aware, willing and competent to use PCEA appropriately	
Ensure only the patient uses the PCEA button	
Ensure that the cannula is patent and site shows no signs of infection and dressing intact	
Able to measure, record and interpret • PCEA demands and good • Sedation score • Pain score • Nausea score • Blood pressure • Pulse • Respiratory rate • Temperature	
Able to check epidural catheter insertion site and dressing	
Able to renew epidural infusion and changing of epidural lines according to trust policy	
Able to understand and recognise the signs of epidural complications and side effects and refer promptly to appropriate authority (Acute Pain Team or Anaesthetics)	
Able to assess and treat side effects of epidural opioids • Respiratory depression • Sedation • Nausea and vomiting • Pruritus • Constipation • Hallucinations	

Able to assess and treat side effects of epidural local anaesthetic • Hypotension • Motor Block	
Demonstrates a knowledge of how to treat or refer a patient with inadequate analgesia or inadequate block	
Ensure no other systemic opioids or sedatives are administered while PCEA in progress unless indicated by the acute pain team or anaesthetist	
Able to safely remove epidural catheter in line with trust policy and with regard to patients clotting status	
Acute Pain Service and Recovery Staff Only	
Able to configure and programme PCEA pump to prescribed analgesic regime	
Able to assess and interpret block levels and titrate prescribed epidural regime appropriately	
Acute Pain Service Only	
Able to manipulate epidural catheter to achieve effective epidural anaesthesia	
Able to safely administer epidural bolus	
Able to adjust epidural infusion rate or solution	
Able to recognise inappropriate epidural regimes and refer to relevant authority	

Signatures on Completion:

Signature of Practitioner:	
Print name:	Position:
Department/Team:	Date:
Signature of Assessor:	
Print name:	Position:
Department/Team:	Date:

On completion of this document: The original copy should be retained by the employee for their portfolio; one copy should be retained in the area specific competency log folder in your workplace and one copy sent to workforce development for logging on STAR.